

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

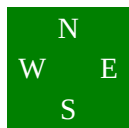
♠ J 9 6
♥ A 7
♦ A 6 5 2
♣ J 10 9 4

♠ A 7

♥ K 6 4

♦ Q J 8 4

♣ K Q 7 3



♠ Q 10 5 4

♥ J 8 3

♦ 10 9 3

♣ A 8 5

♠ K 8 3 2

♥ Q 10 9 5 2

♦ K 7

♣ 6 2

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♥		
All Pass			
3♥ by South			

South plays 3♥. West leads the ♣J.

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Losers: ♠ 2 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 1 : Total = 6

You may be able to ruff 1 ♠ in dummy, and discard another on a long ♦. And you hope to keep your trump losers to 1.

Start by covering the ♣J to set up a sure ♣ trick. East wins the ♣A and returns a ♣, won by dummy's ♣K. It looks better to start the trumps from your side, so play a ♦ toward your ♦K. West wins and plays a ♣, which you ruff. Now lead a ♥, playing the ♥K if West plays low. Assume this wins the trick. Lead a ♥ back, finessing the ♥9 since you think West must hold the ♥A. He does hold it, and takes it right now. West leads a ♠. You win the ♠A in dummy, play the ♠7 to your ♠K, and ruff a ♠ with dummy's last trump. Now lead dummy's ♦ Q J, discarding a ♠ on the last one. You have only good trumps left.

The play for this hand was not straightforward at all, and might have taken a different path had the East/West cards been arranged differently. However, the general approach of ruffing a ♠ in dummy and setting up the ♦ suit would bring the best result with most arrangements.

Because you have an invitational hand with a 4-card Major (♠s) you use Stayman.

After your 2♣ bid partner says 2♦.

Partner does not have 4 (♠s) so you have no 8-card fit there. However, he might have 3 ♥s, so you now bid 2♥. Partner will understand you are showing a 5-card suit.

Partner bids 3♥.

This could go either way. You started out with 9 points, but perhaps you could revalue your hand upward after you find the fit. The problem with that is those two doubletons are in the long-trump hand, and taking ruffs in the long-trump hand doesn't usually add tricks. You take the conservative route and pass.

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 7 5 4 2

♥ A 8 4

♦ 7

♣ 8 7 2

♠ 8

♥ Q 7 5 2

♦ A J 8 2

♣ Q 6 5 3



♠ 10 9 3

♥ J 10 6 3

♦ Q 10 9 3

♣ J 4

♠ A Q 6

♥ K 9

♦ K 6 5 4

♣ A K 10 9

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1♦
Pass	1♥	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♦	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by South

fact that most of your strength is in the black suits should help you decide on 3NT.

You have 19 points, too much for 1NT. With two 4-card minors you should open 1♦, regardless of strength. Partner responds 1♥.

Partner's ♥ bid makes you very happy. It also makes your rebid a snap. With 19 points and a balanced hand you jump to 2NT.

Partner now surprises you a little by saying 3♦.

What is your next bid?

For partner to take you out of Notrump he must have a distributional hand, probably with a singleton or void in one of the black suits. You have to make the choice between passing, bidding 4♦ or 5♦, or bidding 3NT.

While any of those choices might turn out best, the

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♠5. East plays the ♠9.

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Winner count: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 4? : Total = 8?

Those 4 ♣ winners assume a 3-2 split. Since that is going to be the first suit you play you will find out soon enough.

You win the ♠Q. Play the ♣K, then the ♣10 (trying to tempt a cover). Go up with the ♣Q and East follows with the ♣J so you do have 4 ♣ tricks. Take your other two ♣s right now.

You are now at the crossroads. For your ninth trick should you try the ♦ finesse or should you establish a ♥. It's a no-brainer. If you finesse a ♦ and it loses to East's ♦Q a ♠ will come back, knocking out your last stopper. Then, if the ♦s fail to split 3-2 you will be short one winner and it will be too late to set up the ♥. So ignore the finesse and set up a ♥ for your guaranteed nine tricks.

As you can see, with this layout a ♦ finesse would be fatal.

East would win and play a ♠, and whether you ducked this one or not your last stopper would soon be removed. When ♦s failed to split 3-2 you would have been forced to try a ♥. West would win his ♥A and set you with ♠s.

Correctly played you would lead a ♥ honor to establish one trick in the suit and easily make the game with 2 ♠s, 1 ♥, 2 ♦s and 4 ♣s.